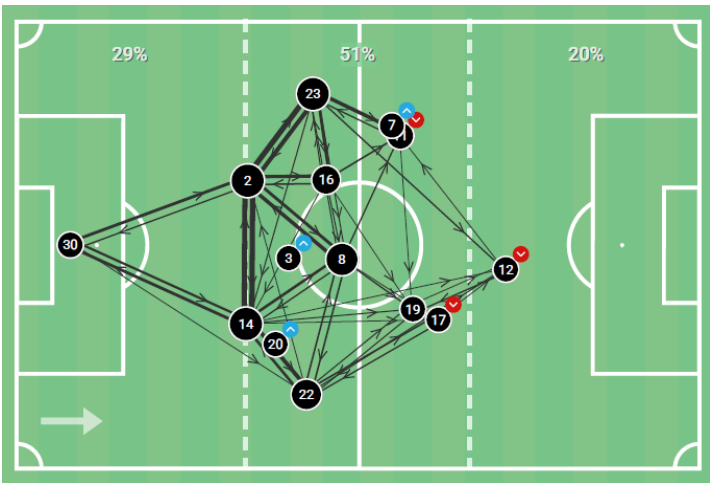


LEAD OPPONENT SCOUTING REPORT

Opponent: Michigan State
Date of Match: 10/17
Compiled By: Soham Mukherjee
Opponent Record: 5-5-1 in Fall 2025 (most recently 0-0 against Northwestern)

Overall Team Overview (over last 6 games):

Michigan State is a possession-oriented team comfortable maintaining the ball, particularly in the opponent’s defensive third. They circulate it well with short-to-medium passes, intelligent movement, and look to exploit openings in the final third. While they prefer buildup play, they’re also willing to go direct, especially through #12, on counterattacks or when space opens up, aiming to hold up play and push numbers forward. Offensively, #10 (1.50 xG, 3 goals) and #17 (1.33 xG, 2 goals) are their main shooting threats, with many of their attacking players registering a high number of shots on goal. Set pieces (typically taken by #8), including corners and long throws, are a key threat, often targeting #23, #17, and #22, and they’re aggressive in attacking second balls around the box. Defensively, they’re vulnerable to balls delivered into the box and often struggle to clear their lines cleanly, frequently conceding from second balls and rebounds in dangerous areas. Applying pressure in their defensive third and committing numbers to capitalize on loose balls has proven effective in creating scoring opportunities.



Passing matrix vs Northwestern

PPDA	10.43	Moderate pressing, high block aimed at disrupting opposition buildup.
Average Possession %	51.5%	Comfortable on the ball, combining hold-up play and 1-2s to create.
Passes per Possession	3.54	Favors short-passing buildup, can play direct if space opens up.
Shots/crosses per 90	12/10	Tend to generate more shots than crosses compared to opponents.
xG per 90	1.01	Shot accuracy varies by opponent but maintains a moderate xG threat.

In Possession:

- Shape: 4-2-3-1 or 4-4-2
- During buildup, strong links between back line and midfielders (#16, #8); GK often involved
- Left-sided buildup, favors short and medium passing

Out of Possession:

- Shape: 4-4-2 with a high block
- Moderate press (PPDA ~10.43); looking to contain opponent buildup
- Struggles to cleanly clear deliveries into the box cleanly, vulnerable to rebound opportunities

Key Players:

- #10 – Richie Ludwig (RW)
 - Right footed, takes snapshots
 - Looks for 1-2s to get behind
- #12 – Chimnosoh Okeke (ST)
 - Strong, athletic, holds up play
 - Leads the team in assists

AI Perspective: Confirms Michigan State’s possession focused buildup (pass accuracy of 77.98%). Highlights that despite a moderate xG output, shot-on-target rate of 30.26% indicates inconsistent accuracy. Defensively, they concede an average of 1.36 goals per game and can be exploited under pressure (force turnovers).